# PGDM Course: Services and Retail Management

**Course Type:** Elective
**Credits:** 3
**Duration:** One Trimester (30 hours)

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### Course Objective

To provide students with a comprehensive understanding of the principles and practices of services and retail management. The course blends traditional frameworks with contemporary developments in service excellence, customer experience, retail formats, and digital transformation.

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# Detailed Syllabus

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### Unit 1: Introduction to Services and Retail Management

- Nature and Characteristics of Services
- Service vs. Goods: Key Differences
- Service Economy and Growth of Service Sector
- Concept and Scope of Retailing
- Role and Importance of Retailing in the Economy
- Service-Retail Interface
- Overview of Service and Retail Ecosystem in India

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### Unit 2: Service Marketing and Service Quality

- Service Marketing Mix (7Ps)
- Service Design and Delivery
- Understanding the Service Encounter and Service Blueprinting
- Managing Service Quality – SERVQUAL Model
- GAP Model of Service Quality
- Customer Expectation and Perception in Services
- Service Recovery and Complaint Handling
- Measuring Service Performance

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## Unit 3: Retail Management Fundamentals

- Retail Formats and Types (Store-based and Non-store)
- Retail Location and Store Layout Decisions
- Merchandise Management and Assortment Planning
- Retail Pricing Strategies
- Retail Supply Chain and Inventory Management
- Retail Store Design, Visual Merchandising, and Atmospherics
- Retail Selling and Salesperson Role

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## Unit 4: Consumer Behavior in Services and Retailing

- Consumer Decision-Making in Service and Retail Contexts
- Factors Influencing Service and Retail Buying Behavior
- Customer Relationship Management (CRM) in Services and Retail
- Building Customer Loyalty and Retention
- Role of Technology in Enhancing Customer Experience
- Service Encounter Management and Moments of Truth

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## Unit 5: Contemporary Trends in Services and Retail

- E-Tailing and Omnichannel Retailing
- Role of Technology and AI in Services and Retail (Chatbots, Personalization, AR/VR)
- Emerging Service Models: Subscription, Sharing, and Experience Economy
- Sustainable and Ethical Retailing Practices
- Retail Analytics and Data-Driven Decision Making
- Global Retail Trends and Future of Services
- Case Studies: Leading Service Brands & Retail Innovators

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## Pedagogy

- Case Studies (Indian and International)
- Role Plays and Group Presentations
- Field Visits to Retail Outlets / Service Organizations
- Guest Lectures by Industry Professionals

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## Suggested Readings


1. Zeithaml, V.A., Bitner, M.J., Gremler, D.D. – *Services Marketing: Integrating Customer Focus Across the Firm*
2. Christopher Lovelock & Jochen Wirtz – *Services Marketing: People, Technology, Strategy*
3. Barry Berman & Joel Evans – *Retail Management: A Strategic Approach*
4. Levy, M. & Weitz, B.A. – *Retailing Management*
5. Recent articles from *Harvard Business Review*, *Retail Dive*, *Economic Times Retail*, etc.